Unit 5 — Digital Friendships

Track E · Klasse 8 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can describe a digital friendship using present perfect (simple).*
- *I can use for / since / ever / never / just / already / yet.*
- *I can write a 120-word reflection on online friendship.*

Lead-in I

Jonas has a friend in Iceland whom he has never met in person. They have been writing to each other on a shared map app for two years. They have already exchanged 287 photos of clouds. They have not yet spoken on the phone. Jonas says, ”It’s a friendship. It just looks weird.”

Reading I

Listening — *The Cloud-Sender*
Jonas and his Icelandic friend Ari started writing to each other on a map app two years ago. Each one drops photos of the sky in their location. Jonas has sent 287 cloud photos. Ari has answered 287 times. They have never met. They have not yet spoken on the phone. Jonas says he just doesn't see the point of phones for this kind of friendship.

Grammar — present perfect simple
Form: *have/has + past participle*.
for + duration: *for two years.* **since** + start point: *since 2024.* **ever / never**: *Have you ever met him? — No, I have never met him.* **just** (recent): *I have just sent the photo.* **already** (sooner than

Reading II

expected): *We have already exchanged 287 photos.* **yet** (not yet completed, in negatives/Q): *We haven't spoken on the phone yet.*

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Insert *for* or *since*: I have known him _____ two years. I have lived here _____ 2024.
2. Place *just / already / yet*: I have ___ sent the message. They have ___ replied. We haven't met ___ .

Niveau E — productive

Practise II

3. Build 4 present-perfect sentences about a friendship: 1 with *for*, 1 with *since*, 1 with *never*, 1 with *yet*.

Your turn I

Reflection, 120 words. Write about a friendship that exists mostly online (or one you imagine could exist). Use 4 present-perfect structures and one *because*-clause.

Sample

I have been writing to Ari for almost two years. We started because of a school project, but we have kept writing because his cloud photos make my afternoons better. We have already exchanged 287 photos. We have never spoken on the phone. We just don't need to. Sometimes I worry that I haven't met him yet, and that the friendship will stay flat. Then he sends another photo of a strange-shaped cloud and I laugh, and the worry feels like the wrong size for the situation.

Reflect I

- I can use present perfect with *for/since/ever/never/just/already/yet*.
- I can describe a digital friendship in 120 words.
- I can spot when present perfect is wrong (with past time markers).

Further reading / listening I

- BBC Learning English — *Present perfect* lessons.
- ChildLine UK — *Online friendships* topic.